

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

FINAL YEAR UNDERGRADUATE EXAMINATIONS 2022-23

RETHINKING MODERNITY

Time allowed: **24 hours**

Time to spend on your assessment: **3 hours**

Maximum word count for assessment: **2,250 words**

Please see your exam timetable or check on FASER for the deadline to upload your answer.

The times shown on your timetable are in UK Time. Please check online for a conversion to your local time if you will be undertaking your assessment outside the United Kingdom.

INSTRUCTIONS

The paper consists of **SIXTEEN** questions in total.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions in total.

All questions are of equal weight.

You may write up to **2,250** words for this paper, a suggested **750** per question.

These questions have been set so that you can answer them within the normal exam time frame which is three hours. You are not expected to spend 24 hours on this assessment.

Referencing and plagiarism

You may consult resources for this take-home exam. You are NOT expected to provide a bibliography.

You must avoid copying from text books, articles, online sources or your own previous work. If you do quote, you must use quotation marks and provide in-text references. Penalties for plagiarism will apply.

You are reminded that collaborating with other students is collusion, which is also an academic offence. Penalties will apply.

Submission

If you have a query with the content of this exam paper contact socugrad@essex.ac.uk

If you have a technical problem with FASER, or any other query, please go to Exams Website to find contact details of the teams that can help you.

Please note that the time allocated for this assessment includes time for you to download this question and answer paper and to upload your question and answers paper to FASER.

Please allow at least 30 minutes at the end of your exam time to upload your work. Once you have completed the assessment do not leave it to the last minute to upload.

Please save your work throughout the examination to avoid losing your work. **You must only submit Microsoft Word documents.**

Please do not communicate with any other candidate in any way during this assessment. Your response must be your own work. Procedures are in place to detect plagiarism and collusion.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions in total:

Candidates must answer **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **either SECTION A or SECTION B**.

SECTION A

1. Can we understand modernity without understanding its relationship to colonialism?
2. Why should sociology make efforts to study the relations between humans and animals?
3. Why has the distinction between “facts” and “values” been problematic for sociology?
4. Identify and explain how language is tied up with wider questions of power.
5. Should sociology use the term “feminism” or “feminisms”?
6. Using the work of at least two authors, explain why the global distribution of wealth/income is an important topic for sociology.
7. Do we need a theory of signs and signification to understand capitalism?
8. What do sociologists mean by the term “standpoint epistemology”? How useful is this approach?

END OF SECTION A

SECTION B

9. How did Foucault challenge traditional sociological approaches to power? How convincing do you find his arguments?
10. What is meant by “scientific racism”? How have sociologists tried to counter this concept?
11. How have post-colonial theorists challenged the distinction between “the West and the Rest”?
12. Donna Haraway stated that ‘How we see the world is always a matter of power’. Explain this statement and its relevance for sociology today.
13. Critically analyse Southern Theory as an alternative to European Modernity. What are its limits?
14. How are non-western models proposing a different relationship between modernity and technology? Discuss with examples.
15. Critically assess the concept of ‘multiple modernities’.
16. Outline and assess the links between climate crisis and capitalism.

END OF SECTION B

END OF QUESTION PAPER

PLEASE SEE NEXT PAGE FOR THE ANSWER SHEET

ANSWER SHEET
(Please use as many sheets as you need to)

Student Registration Number:

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TYPE THE QUESTION NUMBERS AND YOUR ANSWERS HERE: